ALPHATESTER

MUSIC GENERATOR

Desktop App Guide

Download, open, load the models, start. No terminal, no Git, no Python.

1. **Download**
   one package for your system
2. **Open**
   one security prompt
3. **Load models**
   the assistant guides you

As of: version 0.1.2 (test version), October 2026 · developed with Frank Hildebrandt

OVERVIEW AND REQUIREMENTS

What is the desktop app?

The desktop app is Music Generator as a regular program: download, open, done. There is no install command and no terminal. An assistant checks your computer and downloads the models (every file with a checksum). After that everything runs locally on your machine, even without internet. The music engine is the same as in the web app. The app was developed by **Frank Hildebrandt**. It is currently a **test version**: it runs well on our test machines, but it is not yet checked by Apple or Microsoft, so a security prompt appears on first launch.

Which package for which computer

System	File	Requirements
Mac (Apple Silicon)	…-macos-arm64.dmg	macOS 14 or newer, M1 or newer
Mac (Intel)	…-macos-x64.dmg	macOS 13.3 or newer, processor only, very slow (experimental)
Windows	…-windows-x64.zip	Windows 10 or 11, 64-bit; NVIDIA, AMD or processor only
Linux	…-linux-x64.AppImage	Ubuntu 22.04 or newer; Vulkan or processor, plus a CUDA build for NVIDIA (…-linux-x64-cuda.AppImage, 1.4 GB)

The packages are on GitHub at **github.com/rabbitfiremediacreation/music-generator-desktop/releases**, top entry, then expand “Assets” at the bottom (not “Source code”). Next to every package is a .sha256 file for verification; you do not need the “original-builds” file. It is a test version: if the app does not start, see page 6.

Storage and memory

Disk	about 5 GB for the sound model, the 0.6B language model and the title model. XL adds 5.3 GB, the 4B language model 4.7 GB.
Memory (RAM)	8 GB is enough for the standard sound model; the 0.6B language model is the safe choice. The assistant suggests one that fits your computer. XL needs considerably more.

Web-App: The **web app** (Python, with installer) is still available, for Linux with CUDA or ROCm, older Macs and everyone who already uses it. Both versions run independently of each other.

DOWNLOAD, COPY, OPEN FOR THE FIRST TIME

Installation on the Mac

1 Download and copy

Download the .dmg file and double-click it. In the window, drag the **Music Generator** icon onto the **Applications** folder, then eject the image. **Important:** start the app from the Applications folder, not directly from the image. Otherwise it is gone after you eject.

2 Opening it for the first time

macOS blocks the app on first launch because it is not yet checked (notarized) by Apple. This happens with every new version. The way: open the app once and dismiss the message. Then open **System Settings › Privacy & Security**, scroll down to the “Security” section and click **Open Anyway** next to Music Generator (confirm with your password or Touch ID). After that the app starts.

> **Mac:** If no further prompt appears after the click, open the app once more. The packages are built automatically on GitHub; if you want to be sure, check the checksum: **shasum -a 256 filename.dmg** must show the value in the .sha256 file.

3 Intel Macs

On Intel Macs everything runs on the processor. That works but is slow: a 10-second song with the default values (80 iterations) took about 5 minutes on a MacBook Pro with an i5 and 8 GB. Since version 0.1.2 the app suggests 30 iterations on computers without a suitable graphics card and warns before long runs. Start with short songs.

UNZIP, OR START THE APPIMAGE

Installation on Windows and Linux

Windows

Download the .zip file and choose **Extract All** from the right-click menu, onto a local drive, not a network drive. The extracted folder contains **Music Generator.exe** and the folders **engine** and **WebView2**. These three must stay together. Then double-click the EXE.

> **Windows:** Windows says: “Windows protected your PC. Microsoft Defender SmartScreen prevented an unrecognized app from starting.” Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. This happens once with every new version.

The first start can take a few seconds, and the window stays dark or empty at first. Just wait, the assistant appears by itself. If an antivirus program complains: page 6.

Linux

Download the .AppImage file, make it executable (**chmod +x filename** or in the file manager under Properties) and start it. If FUSE is missing:

```
./Music-Generator-0.1.2-linux-x64.AppImage --appimage-extract
./squashfs-root/AppRun
```

The AppImage uses Vulkan or the processor (AMD, Intel, NVIDIA). For NVIDIA cards there is also the CUDA build (…-linux-x64-cuda.AppImage, 1.4 GB); it only needs a current NVIDIA driver. For AMD with ROCm the web app remains the better choice (see the installation guide, last page). On Linux we have tested the app less than on Mac and Windows.

SET UP ONCE, THEN MAKE MUSIC

Setup assistant and first song

1 The setup assistant

On first launch an assistant guides you: choose the language, check the hardware (memory, graphics card) and let it suggest a language model, choose locations for models and songs (the default is fine), then download the models. The download can be cancelled and resumed later. At the end a short function test runs.

The standard sound model and a language model are required. **XL** sounds better according to the developers, but takes about twice as long and needs more memory; it can be added later. A small title model (0.6 GB) names finished songs automatically.

If you come from the web app, choose **Import library** in the assistant: pick the project folder of the old installation (the folder with the file **music.db**, not the “songs” subfolder), choose the destination folder for the songs and review. Songs and titles are copied, the old installation stays unchanged.

2 The first song

In the studio on the left enter a **prompt** (what it is about) and a **style** (genre, instruments, mood), set the **length** to 30 seconds and press **Generate**. If the title stays empty, one is created automatically. A display shows the phases; finished songs appear in the library on the right.

How long it takes (80 iterations, standard sound model)

Computer	Duration
MacBook M1, 8 GB	30-second song: about 1:50 minutes
Windows PC with GTX 1060 (6 GB)	30-second song: about 1:40 minutes
Windows PC, processor only	30-second song: about 2 minutes
MacBook Pro with Intel i5, processor only	10-second song: about 5 minutes

Measured in our tests with versions 0.1.1 and 0.1.2. The time depends heavily on the computer. Where no suitable graphics card is working, fewer iterations help (for example 30), set under “Advanced”.

SETTINGS, UPDATES, WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Everyday use, data and help

Settings (gear icon)

Language model runs on	Automatic or “CPU only”. If a song sounds distorted or awful (for example on M3 or M4), choose “CPU only”.
Export	WAV (lossless) or MP3 (192 kbit/s). The library always keeps the WAV.
Change song location	Moves your songs to another folder, with a progress bar.
Expert mode	Unlocks Turbo models and further model families.
Reopen setup assistant	Repeat locations, model downloads and function test, also to add XL later.

Length, BPM, iterations, variance and versions are restored at the next start. “Reset basic settings” restores the defaults.

Data and updates

macOS	~/Library/Containers/de.alphatester.music-generator/
Windows	%LOCALAPPDATA%\de.alphatester.music-generator\
Linux	~/.local/share/de.alphatester.music-generator/

That is where the database, settings, log files (logs/desktop.log) and, unless you choose otherwise, models and songs live. **Update:** download the new version and replace the old app (Mac: overwrite in the Applications folder; Windows: unzip into a new folder). Your data is kept.

When something goes wrong

Problem	Solution
Security prompt at start	Normal with every new version: Mac page 3, Windows page 4.
“Startup failed”, “The startup window did not become ready” or the window stays empty	Known bug of test version 0.1.2, a fix is being worked on. First “Try again”, then quit the app completely and start it again. If that does not help, the web app runs independently (installation guide).
A song aborts with “timeout”	Raise the timeout in the settings, choose shorter songs or fewer iterations.
MP3 cannot be selected or the export fails	Choose WAV. Some antivirus programs block the bundled MP3 converter.
An antivirus program raises an alarm	The program files are not signed yet. Check the checksum, then exclude the program folder from scanning.

Help and bug reports: **github.com/rabbitfiremediacreation/music-generator-desktop** › Issues. Please include version, system and the log.